



Jordan Tinsel

FINANCE DIRECTOR

The numbers always add up. Almost always.

FOR JORDAN TINSEL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Nick's business partner for ten years and the company's numbers person. You carried Nick's red mug to him at the 9 o'clock toast.

COSTUME

Easy: Sharp suit, tinsel scarf, calculator.

Go all out: a velvet blazer or three-piece suit, a gold tinsel scarf, a pocket watch and a ledger under one arm.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your business partner of ten years
- **Morgan Ivy:** Nick's assistant; you see each other every day
- **Charlie Bell:** always asking you for budget for the newsletter

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Keep company business confidential, whatever happens
- Make sure nobody blames you for carrying the mug
- Find out who was listening at the study door

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You've been Nick's business partner for ten years. You're the numbers person. At the 9:00 toast, you carried Nick's red mug from the kitchen to him. Casey had filled it from the eggnog bowl.

YOUR SECRET

Two years ago you "borrowed" \$20,000 from the company's charity Toy Drive fund to cover a reindeer-farm investment that failed. Nick found out last week. He said you'd repay it from your sale bonus or he'd go to the police. You also spent 3:00 to 5:00 today in the study with Nick, signing the sale of Frost & Fable to MegaMart. Nobody else is supposed to know about the sale yet.

You are innocent

Your alibi: you were in the study with Nick from 3:00 to 5:00, so you couldn't have gone to the greenhouse.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Jordan



Your manner: Brisk, guarded and precise. Check your watch, answer questions with numbers and never volunteer anything you don't have to.

LINES TO TRY

- "I don't deal in rumours. I deal in figures."
- "Company business is confidential. Even tonight."
- "I carried a mug across a room. That's all."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Stay cool: "I was in the study with Nick from three to five. Check the notes."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Admit you carried the mug, but you never opened it and Casey poured it. Keep the sale and the charity fund secret. Ask Alex why they turned up uninvited. Ask Robin what they gave Nick for Secret Santa.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Nick's red "Big Boss" mug was a joke present from the staff years ago. Nobody else ever used it.
- Gossip: Alex Snow arrived uninvited at 7:15 and went straight over to Nick.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Casey who else was in the kitchen just before the toast.
- Ask Charlie whether there's a photo of you handing over the mug.

MINI TASK

Get Casey to confirm, in front of a witness, that Casey filled the mug and you only carried it.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: When your meeting notes are revealed, admit the sale. Add this: at about 3:30 you heard the hall floorboards creak and smelled sawdust and wood varnish, as though someone had been standing outside the door.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Refuse to say the sale price. "That's confidential, even tonight."
- Gossip: this morning Nick said he had "one unpleasant job" left to do before the party.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Quinn what *Toy Trade Weekly* knows about the sale.
- Ask who in the lodge smells of sawdust and wood varnish. Who works with wood all day?

MINI TASK

Find out who was standing outside the study door at about 3:30.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: If pressed about money, confess the charity fund. Insist that Nick alive was your only way to repay it quietly. With Nick dead, the sale might fall through.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Say you always meant to repay every cent from your bonus.
- Point out that you were in the study with Nick from 3:00 to 5:00. The meeting notes prove it.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Taylor who they have been texting all night.
- Ask Morgan whether anyone else used Nick's study today.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, walk the room through your afternoon, minute by minute, in under a minute.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim